

Tikeshwar Singh

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Education

Master of Arts in Economics, Azim Premji University, Bengaluru, 2026

Bachelor of Commerce, Government Degree College, Kullu, 2024

Research Experience

Predoctoral Research Associate, King's College London, Patna, Bihar, Sep 2026–Present
Principal Investigator: Prof. Amrita Dhillon ; *Co-applicants:* Prof. Chinmaya Kumar (Azim Premji University, Bengaluru), Dr. Arka Roy Chaudhuri (Shiv Nadar University) and Aaditya Dar (Independent Researcher)

- Working on *Can AI-Generated Transparency Rebuild Civic Engagement? Experimental Evidence from Bihar, India*, studying whether AI-generated transparency can influence citizens' trust in government and civic engagement.
- Cleaning, standardizing, and validating LLM-extracted data through systematic quality checks to identify extraction errors and inconsistencies and construct a reliable analysis-ready dataset.
- Supporting the preparation of a pilot randomized experiment in Bihar, with planned responsibilities including survey instrument development, enumerator training, and SurveyCTO-based data collection.

Research Associate (Part-Time), University of Louisville & Harvard University, Remote, Nov 2025–Jan 2026

Supervisors: Prof. Anirvan Chowdhury (University of Louisville) and Varun Kapoor (Academy Scholar, Harvard University)

- Geocoded 55,000 school locations from the District Information System for Education (DISE) and Vidya Bharati (VB) datasets using Jupyter Notebook for the *Social Engineering through Schools* project.
- Performed quality checks by manually verifying school coordinates in Google Earth Pro for selected districts.

Research Associate (Part-Time), Harvard University & Madras Institute of Development Studies (MIDS), Remote, Sep–Nov 2025

Supervisors: Varun Kapoor (Academy Scholar, Harvard University) and Prof. A. Kalaiyarasan (MIDS)

- Transformed an existing dataset of Periyar's travelogues by standardizing location names, geocoding coordinates, and validating entries across India for the *Self-Respect Movement* project using R and Excel.

- Automated classification of 7,149 historical events in R using string matching.

Research Intern, Centre for the Study of the Indian Economy (CSIE), Azim Premji University, Patna, Bihar, Jun–Jul 2025

Supervisor: Prof. Chinmaya Kumar (Azim Premji University, Bengaluru)

- Worked on *Why Do Firms Hire Migrant Workers?*, a cross-randomized field experiment examining employer hiring preferences in informal labor markets.
- Assisted and supervised 5 enumerators during the pilot survey and facilitated interviews with 25 construction contractors and 15 households to collect primary data using SurveyCTO.
- Assisted with questionnaire design and piloting, reviewed and refined enumerator training materials, trained 5 enumerators, and conducted audio audits for data quality during implementation.

Field Immersion, Azim Premji Foundation, Bengaluru Urban, Karnataka, Dec 2024

Supervisor: Prof. Srishti Yadav (Azim Premji University, Bengaluru)

- Conducted 30 semi-structured informal interviews with key village stakeholders, including the Panchayat Development Officer, ward members, ASHA workers and Anganwadi workers, to evaluate government service delivery systems.
- Independently designed the interview questionnaire, conducted an in-depth interview with the Panchayat librarian, and prepared a report on the library’s functioning and community impact.

Skills

Programming Languages: R, Stata, Python

Statistical Techniques: Causal Inference, Time Series Analysis, Principal Component Analysis

Software and Tools: QGIS, L^AT_EX

Field & Survey Tools: SurveyCTO, Questionnaire Design, Household Surveys, Experimental Surveys, Enumerator Training, Pilot Testing

Courses

BREAD–IGC Virtual PhD Course on Political Economy, International Growth Centre (IGC), Sep–Nov 2026 (Present) (*Fall 2026*)

BREAD–IGC Virtual PhD Course on Social Protection, International Growth Centre (IGC) (*Fall 2025; lectures independently studied*)

BREAD–IGC Virtual PhD Course on Urban Economics, International Growth Centre (IGC) (*Fall 2024; lectures independently studied*)

BREAD–IGC Virtual PhD Course on Environmental Economics, International Growth Centre (IGC) (*Fall 2023; lectures independently studied*)

BREAD–IGC Virtual PhD Course on Firms and Development, International Growth Centre (IGC) (Spring 2023; lectures independently studied)

BREAD–IGC Virtual PhD Courses on Education; Credit, Insurance, and Risk; and Migration, International Growth Centre (IGC) (Spring 2022; lectures independently studied)

Certifications

Data Analysis with R Specialization

The Stata Omnibus: Regression and Modelling with Stata

Mastering Geospatial Analysis with QGIS

Framework for Data Collection and Analysis

Academic Achievements

Srinivasa Ramanujan Student Digital Yojana, Government of Himachal Pradesh, INR 16,000, 2026 (awarded for undergraduate merit)

Himachal Pradesh Board of School Education Scholarship, INR 30,000 (total), 2021–23

Rank 39, Himachal Pradesh Senior Secondary Examination, 2021

Personal

Languages: English, Hindi

Citizenship: Indian

References

Varun Kapoor

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and Area Studies, Harvard University
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